# Day 8 (stop 2 of 2) - Lower Falls, Louth, Staff Avenue, Midway

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Niagara section · hike 11 · Louth Conservation Area

| 3.4 km / 2.1 mi | ~1.0 h | 2.7 km new | 77 min |
|---|---|---|---|
| total walking | hiking, plus stops | side trail covered | drive from home, Sat 7 am |

**Park:** Louth Conservation Area: Enter from Staff Ave, 500 m north of Pelham Rd (Regional Rd 69). Google Maps.

**Navigate:** import *day08b_hike011.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

**Side trails covered:** Lower Falls Side Trail (1.6 km); Louth Side Trail (0.6 km); Staff Avenue Side Trail (0.3 km); Midway Side Trail (0.2 km)

**Same day:** this is stop 2 of 2 on day 8 (7.2 mi of hiking, about 151 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 1: hike 10, 5.1 mi from On the north side of King Street (Hwy 81).

## Route map




## What to expect

- **Parking:** Louth Conservation Area is entered from Staff Ave, 500 m north of Pelham Rd (Regional Rd 69). Signage is sparse. There are no washrooms. The area is open year-round from sunrise to sunset; NPCA gives no fee details (905-788-3135).
- **Staff Avenue Side Trail:** A well-defined path from the lot into the woods that meets the main trail. Horses use this trail, so watch for them.
- **Main Bruce Trail & Louth Falls:** Escarpment forest above the Sixteen Mile Creek valley, with old rock formations and songbirds. Louth Falls is near the Louth Side Trail junction. The gorge has no easy way down, so enjoy the view from above.
- **Louth & Midway Side Trails:** Short side trails off the main trail; the Louth Side Trail does not lead to the falls. No terrain details were found.
- **Dogs & hemlocks:** NPCA asks you to stay on trails and keep dogs leashed. This helps limit the spread of hemlock woolly adelgid, an invasive pest found nearby. Clean boots and gear, and don't take branches or twigs.

## Turn-by-turn

| km | mi | Directions |
|---|---|---|
| 0.0 | 0.0 | Start at the parking: Louth Conservation Area: Enter from Staff Ave, 500 m north of Pelham Rd (Regional Rd 69). Head north on the blue-blazed Staff Avenue Side Trail. |
| 0.3 | 0.2 | J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.) Then, turn right onto the blue-blazed Louth Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.) |
| 0.9 | 0.6 | J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.) |
| 1.2 | 0.7 | J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Lower Falls Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.) |
| 2.8 | 1.7 | J4: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Midway Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.) |
| 3.0 | 1.9 | J5: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.) |
| 3.1 | 1.9 | J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the Louth Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.) Then, continue straight onto the blue-blazed Staff Avenue Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.) |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 3.4 | 2.1 | Back at the parking. Hike complete. |

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on NPCA and Go Waterfalling.